

Heat stress isn't just "feeling hot". It can impair judgement, slow reaction time, and lead to heat exhaustion or heat stroke, which is a medical emergency.

Most serious cases happen because people push through instead of speaking up.

## Key controls to Manage Heat Stress

### Hydration

- Drink small amounts often, don't wait until you're thirsty
- Water first; electrolytes if sweating heavily
- Avoid energy drinks and excessive caffeine

### Work / Rest Balance

- Take planned breaks in shade or cool areas
- Rotate high-exertion tasks
- Slow the pace, productivity drops sharply once heat stress sets in

### Clothing and PPE

- Light, breathable clothing where possible
- Manage PPE smartly, if safe, remove it during breaks to cool down

## Early Warning Signs

Heavy sweating or sudden stop in sweating

Dizziness, headache, nausea

Muscle cramps

Fatigue or confusion

Irritability or poor decision making

## What to do if someone shows symptoms

- Stop work immediately
- Move them to shade or a cool area
- Loosen clothing / PPE
- Give cool water (if conscious)
- Call for medical help if symptoms don't improve quickly or if confusion occurs